

Pharmacy DPDPA Starter Checklist

Your pharmacy doesn't just sell medicines — it stores prescription and medicine-history data every day. Work through these ten areas to bring prescription handling, medicine-history controls, vendor sharing, staff access and old-record retention under DPDPA-ready control.

Prescriptions

Medicine History

WhatsApp Orders

Refill Reminders

Delivery Partners

Health Indicators

Billing Software

Old Records

How to use this: tick what you already do, and turn the unticked boxes into your next actions. Start with prescription handling, medicine-history controls and delivery-partner access — they remove the most risk for the least effort.

1 Prescription collection

- ☐ List where prescriptions are collected — in-store, WhatsApp, app/website, doctor, delivery agent.
- ☐ Collect only the prescription and customer data the order actually needs.
- ☐ Prefer a secure app or website upload over WhatsApp and email.
- ☐ Keep one primary billing/POS record so you always know what you hold.
- ☐ Tell customers how their prescription and contact data will be used.

2 WhatsApp prescription handling

- ☐ Reduce prescription images arriving and sitting in WhatsApp.
- ☐ Verify the recipient's number before sending any prescription or order detail.
- ☐ Don't forward prescriptions into staff or vendor WhatsApp groups.
- ☐ Clear prescription images from chats once moved into your system.
- ☐ Use business channels, not staff personal phones, for prescriptions.

3 Medicine-history & health indicators

- ☐ Treat medicine order history as high-impact — it can reveal health conditions.
- ☐ Limit who can view medicine history and condition notes.
- ☐ Don't use chronic-care, mental-health or other high-impact categories for targeting without consent.
- ☐ Avoid storing diagnosis notes unless genuinely needed.
- ☐ Apply extra care to fertility, sexual-health, oncology and HIV-related records.

4 Refill reminder & promotional messaging

- ☐ Get clear opt-in before sending refill or promotional messages.
- ☐ Offer an easy unsubscribe and honour preferences.
- ☐ Don't base health-related reminders on medicine history without separate consent.
- ☐ Keep a record of consent and message preferences.
- ☐ Separate transactional order updates from promotional messaging.

5 Delivery partner data-sharing

- ☐ Share only what delivery partners need for fulfilment — not full prescription details.
- ☐ Keep a register of which delivery and courier partners receive customer data.
- ☐ Confirm what each partner stores and for how long.
- ☐ Instruct delivery staff to use business channels, not personal phones.
- ☐ Review delivery-partner access and sharing periodically.

6 Pharmacy billing / POS software access

- ☐ Consolidate prescriptions and orders into billing/POS software with role-based access.
- ☐ Limit which staff can view full customer and prescription records.
- ☐ Turn on MFA on billing, email, cloud and online-pharmacy accounts.
- ☐ Avoid keeping prescription data in loose sheets, inboxes and staff devices.
- ☐ Review who can access prescription records at least twice a year.

7 Staff, branch & vendor access

- ☐ Give pharmacists, counter and delivery staff only the access their role needs.
- ☐ Don't share logins or passwords across staff or branches.
- ☐ Remove ex-staff and old vendor/branch access the same day they leave.
- ☐ Keep branch-level systems consistent and access-controlled.
- ☐ Limit IT and software-vendor access to what support actually requires.

8 Online pharmacy & telemedicine partners

- ☐ Know what customer and prescription data online platforms and aggregators hold.
- ☐ Share only what telemedicine and platform partners need for the service.
- ☐ Confirm data-sharing terms and retention with each platform partner.
- ☐ Apply a retention rule to data pulled from online dashboards.
- ☐ Restrict which staff can access platform and telemedicine dashboards.

9 Old prescription & order-history retention

- ☐ Set a retention period for old prescriptions, medicine history and WhatsApp orders.
- ☐ Don't keep customer and prescription records indefinitely for convenience or refills.
- ☐ Schedule a periodic review to archive or delete records past their period.
- ☐ Offer customers a way to request correction or deletion of old data.
- ☐ Write retention rules down so the whole team applies them consistently.

10 Wrong-prescription sharing & breach response

- ☐ Write a one-page plan: who to call and what to do first if a prescription reaches the wrong person.
- ☐ Know how to quickly lock a compromised WhatsApp, email or billing account.
- ☐ Keep a contact list (IT, software vendor, and a way to reach affected customers).
- ☐ Be ready to notify the Data Protection Board and affected customers as required.
- ☐ After any incident, record what happened and what you changed.